

User Study Instructions: Personalizing a Conversational Agent

1 Introduction

Thank you for participating in this user study.

In this study, you will use a web-based modeling tool to personalize a given conversational agent. The goal is to evaluate how intuitive and usable the agent personalization process is for users with different technical backgrounds.

Please follow the instructions carefully and feel free to ask questions if anything is unclear. The tool will be accessible online via a link that will be provided once the tasks will start.

2 Scenario Description

You are working for a company that provides digital assistants for fitness centers. Your task is to personalize a conversational agent so that it better supports different types of users.

Your tasks will be to take the base agent model and model how the agent should adapt its behavior and communication style to these users.

3 System Requirements (Base Agent)

3.1 General Purpose

The agent acts as a **gym assistant** that provides advice related to:

- physical exercises,
- nutrition,
- and any other questions related to gyms.

3.2 Conversation Flow

The agent:

- greets the user when the conversation starts,
- waits for user questions,
- classifies questions into topics (training, nutrition, or other),
- provides a **generic** response,
- and then returns to an idle state waiting for new questions.

3.3 Limitations

Obviously, the content of the given answers, the used languages, style, etc, might not fit every user in an optimal way.

4 Target User Profiles

As mentioned, different users might have different expectations or needs. For that purpose, when developing the agent, we will need to have different user profiles in mind as well. Thus, the conversational agent will need to show adapted behavior for the profiles "Elderly User" and "Paraplegic User", providing adapted content, way of speech, etc.

In the following, we clearly define the two profiles and their needs.

Profile A: Elderly User

An elderly user with the following characteristics and needs:

- age above 65,
- prefers simple explanations,
- prefers oral (spoken) interaction,
- and is more comfortable with formal language.

Profile B: Paraplegic user

A paraplegic user with the following characteristics and needs:

- cannot move lower body due to being paraplegic
- needs adapted recommendations for workouts.

5 Your Tasks

Please complete the following tasks in the given order.

Task 0: Accessing the model editor web page

1. Open any browser you like
2. Navigate to `https://editor.besser-pearl.org`
3. Choose any project name

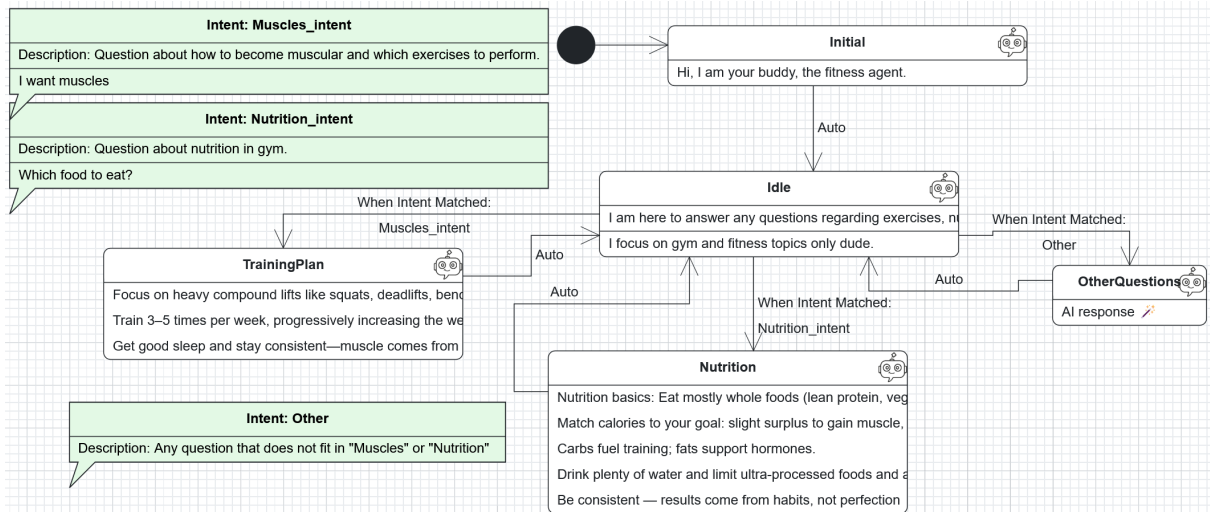


Figure 1: Base agent

Task 1: Inspect and understand the Base Agent

1. On the editor, navigate to the "Agent Diagram" editor page. In this part of the page, you are able to create your own agents and define how they should behave.
2. In the upper navigation bar, open the File menu, Load Template, and choose the gym agent.
3. Inspect the Intent, States and Transitions (you can also use the "Help" menu in the navigation bar):
 - States: Rounded boxes that represent the states in a conversation with the agent (a state also contain which message is sent to the user as a response)
 - Intents: Green boxes that define the accepted user messages
 - Transitions: Define change in conversation state based on a condition (such as a user message)
4. Exchange a few messages with the agent at: <https://gym.besser-pearl.org>
5. Do you feel you understood the agent diagram?
 - If yes, go to the next task.
 - If no, call the study supervisor to discuss which aspects are not clear.

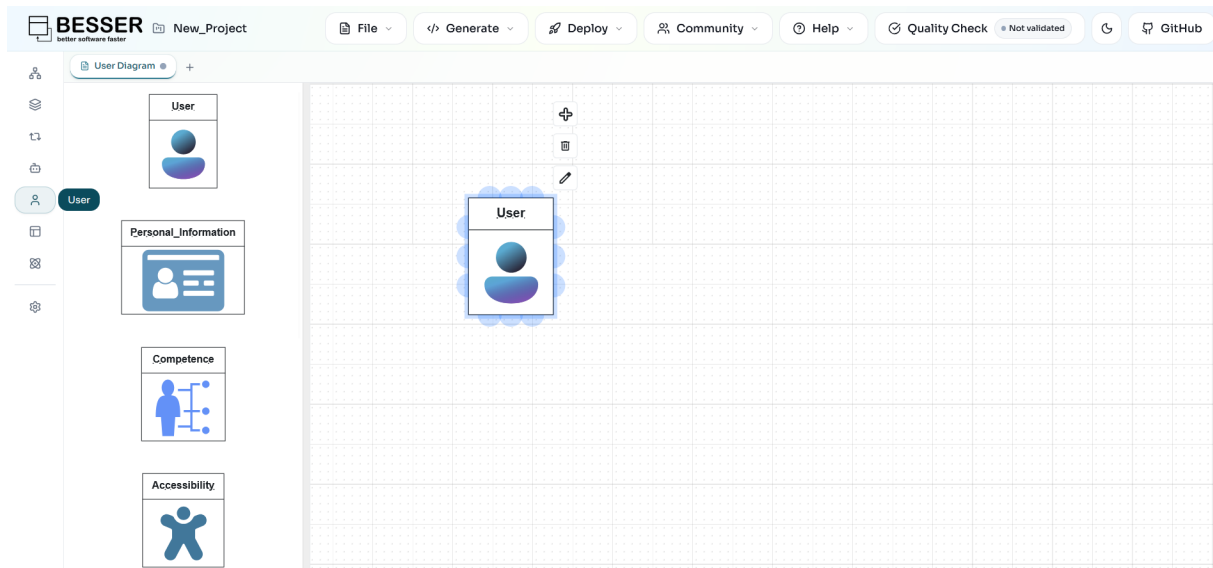


Figure 2: User diagram page

Task 2: Create two User Profiles

You will now proceed with creating the two user profiles that were defined in the requirements.

1. Switch to the "User" editor page, this is the page that allows you to define the users of your agent.
2. Create a user diagram that represents the Elderly User, you need to include the information that:
 - A person aged greater than 65 is considered "Elderly"
3. Use the "Quality check" button to make sure that your model has no syntax errors
4. Name the model by editing the tab
5. Create a second model **in another tab** to represent the "Paraplegic" profile":
 - A paraplegic user is one that has accessibility constraints.
 - Specifically, a Disability will be present with the information
 - Name: Paraplegic
 - Description: Cannott use lower body
 - Affects: Mobility
6. Quality check and name the model

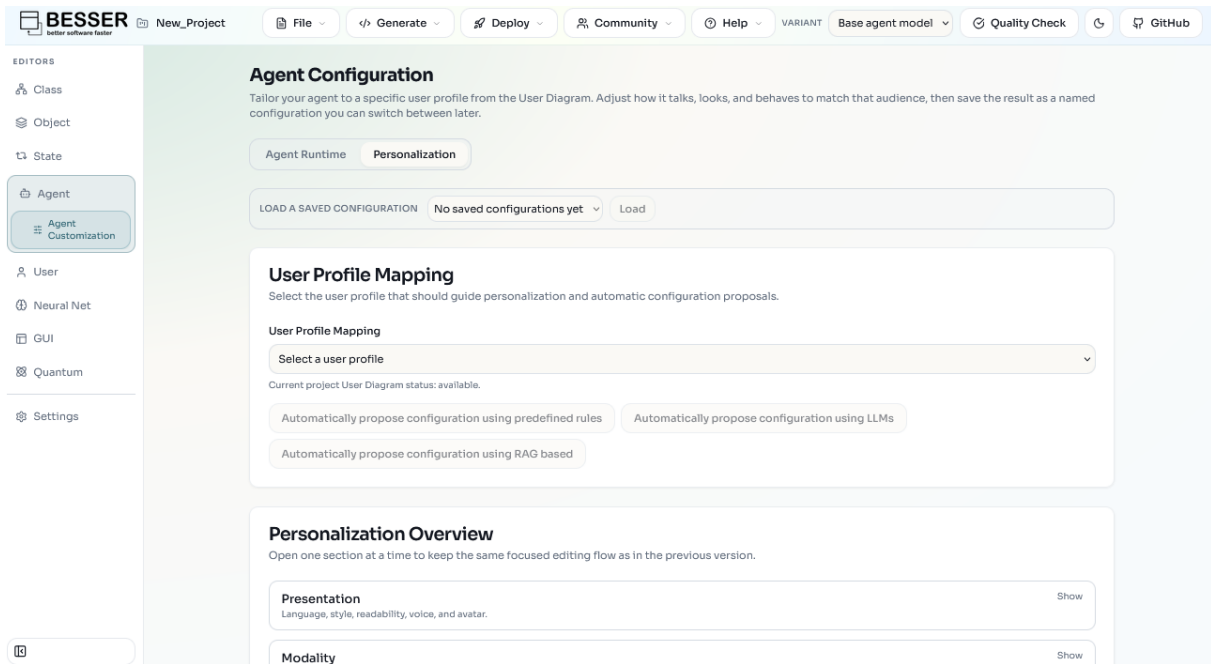


Figure 3: Agent customization page

Task 3: Create Agent Customizations

1. Go back to the agent editor and then go to the agent customization page.
2. In Agent Runtime, set "Intent Recognition" to "LLM-based"
 - Note: For the sake of performance, we delegate processing of user messages to external services
3. Switch to the "Personalization" tab, Now, you will take care of defining an adapted version of the base agent by configuring relevant aspects.
4. Create an agent customization fitting the needs of the "Elderly" profile (note that you can use any of the available functionalities from the page):
 - (a) Start by choosing the user profile you want to create the agent customization for.
 - (b) An elderly person expects:
 - Simple and Formal language
 - Oral interaction
5. Once configured, save and apply the changes to the base agent model. This might take a while. You can now go back to the agent diagram to verify the changed model.
6. Create now a customization for the paraplegic profile:
 - (a) The provided content needs to be adapted to fit the needs of a person that cannot use their legs.
7. Save and apply.

Task 4: Using the agent

You can now either:

- Option A: generate the agent's code, download it and run it locally.
- OR Option B: deploy it on an online server for free. Note that this option leads to slower responses.

Follow the fitting option in the following.

Option A

1. Prerequisites:
 - Python 3.11 or 3.12
 - `pip install besser-agentic-framework[all]`
 - docker to run a database
2. Using the generate button in the navigation bar, select "BESSER Agent" and then choose the "Personalization" option. This will produce the code of the agent.
3. In the previous step, a zip will have been downloaded, extract its content.
4. An adapted config file is available here "<https://github.com/BESSER-PEARL/BESSER-education>" in lab7, and ask the instructor to provide you with a valid openai api key
5. Additionally, you'll need a database running, you'll find a dockerfile for that in the repository
 - When downloaded, go to the folder containing the Dockerfile of the database
 - Build it with: `"docker build -t agentdb ."`
 - Run it with: `"docker run -p 5432:5432"`
6. In the extracted folder, right click and press "open in terminal".
7. Enter and execute the command `"python Gym_Diagram.py"`
8. After a while, a page will be started automatically on `http://localhost:5000` (open manually after 2 min)

Option B

1. Use the deploy button in the editor
 - You'll prompted to log into GitHub and Render
 - Once logged in, you'll need to enter a openai API key, this will be provided to you
 - The deployment process could take up to 8 minutes!
 - Once the process is done, do the following in Render:
 - Go to projects
 - Click on the project that has "agent" in the name
 - Open the URL that contains your project name and ends with "onrender.com"

Task 5: Interact with the agent

1. Login with:
 - Any username and pw combination works
2. Open the profile picker menu and choose any profile
3. Proceed to chat with the agent

6 Questionnaire

After completing the tasks, please answer the questionnaire available under: <https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSdWzZY2qzmtinsLeRY1pX5wMlN9StnkZyYm1M8VermeBjN7cg/viewform?usp=header>

7 Thank You

Thank you for your participation. Your feedback is highly valuable and will help improve the system.